Combined Candidate Report

Meera Venkataraman · General Manager, Plant Automation & Digitalisation · prepared for the CHRO

▲ SAMPLE Behavioural and technical data are Meera's real Recruit41 evaluation and resume. The psychometric references use a Thomas DISC report registered to a different name, since Meera's own profile has not been shared yet. Treat those specific lines as illustrative until it is swapped in.

EXECUTIVE SNAPSHOT

EXPERIENCE	CURRENT ROLE	DEFINING STINT	EDUCATION
19 yrs	General Manager (IT), Kestrel Cooling Systems — since Jul '25	6 yrs, Ardent Electricals as Asst. GM (IT, Manufacturing) — SAP S/4HANA, MES rollout, digital twin, product traceability	B.E. Electronics & Communication · Executive PGDM, Operations (2025)

APPLYING FOR

GM, Plant Automation & Digitalisation

RECOMMENDATION

Advance — with a targeted next round

3.2/5

AVG. OF BEHAVIOURAL & TECHNICAL SCORES

Meera is a **proven builder of plant-digitalisation programmes**, not a paper candidate. Over six years at Ardent she took SAP S/4HANA, an MES rollout and end-to-end traceability automation from pilot to plant-wide adoption, and did it by earning buy-in from operators and IT rather than mandating change from above. That pattern holds independently across the two scored assessments, the behavioural interview (3.3/5) and the technical interview (3.05/5 across its two technofunctional sections), and lines up directionally with the illustrative psychometric read too.

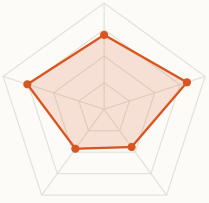
The open question isn't whether she can build. It's whether she's ready to run a **GM-level automation function under pressure**. Pressure-tested on a live crisis scenario, she stayed composed and refused to assign blame under provocation, a real GM-relevant instinct, but hadn't sequenced a response or a plan for the executives waiting on answers. Pressure-tested on IIoT and cloud architecture, she correctly identified the core PLC-to-MES middleware but guessed at a cloud tool that doesn't exist. Both are specific gaps sitting alongside real strengths, not blanket weaknesses: whether they're workable at Northwind depends on how much of that layer your own team already covers, which only you can judge.

Why Meera clears the bar

- Sustained a six-month digitalisation rollout by bringing plant ops, IT and leadership in at inception, not sign-off **(4.1/5, Stakeholder Alignment)**.
- Turned a stalled rollout into a self-sustaining champions network, taking it to full adoption rather than patching it once **(4.0/5, Failure Ownership)**.
- Fluent, practised rollout playbook: phased pilots, legacy-machine integration, training in operators' own language **(3.8/5)**.

What to verify before deciding

- Lowest score in this report: no sequenced incident response or executive communication plan under live crisis pressure **(2.2/5, below bar)**.
- Weakest *technical* score: guessed a non-existent cloud tool, no hands-on edge-computing experience **(2.3/5, below bar)**.
- Only one, recoverable decision example offered; judgment under real stakes remains untested **(3.0/5, Decision Judgment)**.



Decision-making	3.5
Stakeholder & influence	4.1
Crisis leadership	2.2
Technical depth (IIoT)	2.3
Change execution	3.8

Bottom line: advance her, but treat the crisis-leadership and IIoT/cloud gaps as things to staff around or stress-test further, not as answered questions. Page 4 turns each gap into the specific question only you can answer from Northwind's own plant context.

BEHAVIOURAL + PSYCHOMETRIC (SAMPLE)

Influences by consent, not command, until the room turns hostile

- → **Above bar (4.1/5):** earns buy-in early, redesigns around resistance instead of overriding it.
- → **Below bar (2.2/5):** stayed composed and refused to assign blame under provocation, but hadn't sequenced a plan or named stakeholders when tested on a live crisis.

Across the six-month SAP/MES rollout at Ardent, Meera's default move was to bring plant operations, corporate IT and senior management in **before** the design was set, then keep them there through a weekly champions cadence. When operators resisted a new barcode-scanning step, she didn't push through it. She found the real objection (added manual effort) and redesigned the workflow around it. That's a textbook lateral-influence pattern, and it's corroborated independently by the technical interview's change-management thread (rated 4.2/5).

The placeholder DISC sample adds a useful, if illustrative, wrinkle: a profile like this tends to be **reserved and fact-first** rather than relationship-first, which can read as distant to an audience that wants to feel heard, not just informed. Meera's actual track record didn't show that cost, but it's the kind of tension her real psychometric report should be checked against.

> *"Sold the change to operators as the end of manual batch logging rather than as an IT initiative, and to finance as a traceability guarantee rather than a systems upgrade."*

Where the pattern is only partly tested is under acute pressure. **What held up:** she stayed composed, refused to assign blame under provocation, and kept steering the vendors toward resolution rather than a fight. That is the accountability posture the scenario was built to test, and a real GM-relevant instinct. **What didn't yet show up:** a sequenced response, the two stakeholders she was explicitly asked to align, and a plan for the growing operational backlog. **Rated 2.2/5, below bar.** Composure was there; the operating discipline around it wasn't yet.

Read together: she leads change well when she can set the pace and bring people along. The six-month rollout proves that, and her instinct to stay calm and own the problem rather than deflect carries over into a crisis too. What's untested is compressing that same instinct into an hour, with people who don't want to cooperate and answers owed upward. Those are adjacent muscles, not opposite ones, and a GM role tests both.

SCENARIO — THE ROLLOUT

Digitalising SAP/MES across the shop floor over six months, with operators who had to change how they physically worked.

4.1 ABOVE BAR

SCENARIO — THE PUSHBACK

Plant operators refused a new step that added manual labour. **Resolved by redesigning the workflow, not escalating.**

4.0 ABOVE BAR

SCENARIO — THE CRISIS

A live role-play: a vendor integration fails mid-shift, trucks back up at the gate, and a CIO and Head of Supply Chain want a plan within the hour. **Stayed composed, refused to assign blame, but didn't sequence a response.**

2.2 BELOW BAR

PSYCHOMETRIC (SAMPLE)

"Influences with facts and figures rather than rapport, and may under-invest in how a message lands." Illustrative only; not yet Meera's own profile.

TECHNOFUNCTIONAL

Strong on the rollout playbook, thin on the IIoT stack underneath it

- **Meets bar (3.8/5):** fluent, practised rollout playbook: phased pilots, legacy-machine integration.
- **Below bar (2.3/5):** correctly named the core PLC-to-MES middleware, but guessed a non-existent cloud tool and has no edge-computing experience. The weaker of the two technical scores.

On the digitalisation-roadmap questions, Meera is fluent: a line-by-line pilot to isolate risk before scaling, hardware protocol converters to pull cycle-time data off legacy machines, training manuals in operators' own language. This is the practised language of someone who has actually run these rollouts, not studied them. **Rated 3.8/5.**

The gap opens on the layer beneath the rollout, the automation and IIoT stack the GM mandate is built on. **What held up:** she correctly named an industrial connectivity platform as PLC-to-MES middleware and mentioned basic data buffering during outages, showing a real working grasp of the integration layer. **What didn't:** she couldn't go deeper into OPC UA or MQTT, and asked about IIoT and cloud architecture directly, she guessed at a tool that doesn't exist and confirmed no hands-on edge-computing experience, defaulting entirely to centralised cloud processing. **Rated 2.3/5, below bar.** The lower of the two technical scores in this report (only crisis leadership, at 2.2/5, rates lower overall), though not a from-scratch technical gap.

Read together: she can run the change-management side of a digitalisation programme without much help. The technical architecture underneath it will need a strong automation/IIoT partner she trusts and defers to. Workable, but a dependency Northwind should plan for going in, not discover after the offer.

SCENARIO — THE PLAYBOOK

"How would you roll out MES to a live plant without stopping production?" Answered with a phased, line-by-line pilot and legacy-machine data extraction.

3.8 MEETS BAR

SCENARIO — THE STACK

Asked to name the cloud IoT and ML services she'd use for predictive maintenance, and where edge computing fits. **Named the core middleware correctly; guessed a non-existent cloud tool and has no edge-computing experience.**

2.3 BELOW BAR

The gaps above aren't disqualifying on their own. Whether they matter depends on plant context only you have. Four things to weigh, ranked by consequence:

01

A strong automation/IIoT owner already in place, or hired alongside her

Weakest technical score: **2.3/5** on cloud/IIoT architecture (the single lowest score overall is crisis leadership, 2.2/5, addressed in condition 2 below). She correctly named the core PLC-to-MES middleware, but guessed at a non-existent cloud tool and has no hands-on edge computing.

YOUR CALL

Does Northwind's plant already have, or is it hiring, a Head of Automation/IIoT who'd own this layer, so Meera directs it rather than personally architects it?

02

A crisis-response structure she can step into, not build from scratch

Stayed composed and refused to assign blame under provocation, the accountability posture the scenario tested for. What was missing was the operating discipline around it: no sequenced incident response, no named stakeholder communication plan. **2.2/5, below bar.**

YOUR CALL

Does Northwind already run incident or war-room protocols for plant-automation failures, an escalation SOP, a control tower?

03

Room to test higher-stakes judgment before it becomes load-bearing

Named a concrete change to her own pre-decision process, which is real reflection. But the only decision example offered was a recoverable rollout setback; judgment under real, alternatives-weighed stakes is still untested. **3.0/5, Decision Judgment.**

YOUR CALL

In this GM role, how much would she own solo in year one versus what stays on your desk?

04

Her communication style reads well against your plant's culture

The placeholder psychometric sample flags a reserved, fact-first style that may "under-invest in how a message lands". Not yet confirmed on Meera's own profile.

YOUR CALL

Is Northwind's shop floor one where a direct, facts-first GM lands well, or does the culture need someone more relational?

If Northwind can answer these four, the **3.2/5 composite** becomes a clear yes or no. Right now it's an accurate read, **strong builder, unproven under pressure**, not yet a hiring decision.